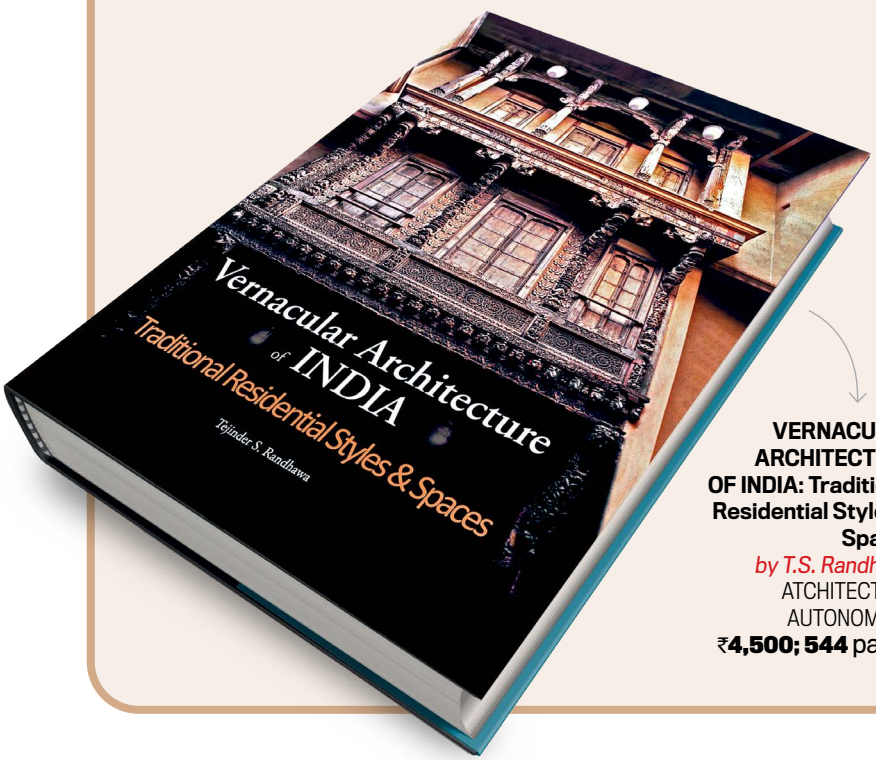
BOOKS

Everyday Creativity

T.S. Randhawa's *Vernacular Architecture of India* is a comprehensive—and stunning—source book on the unsung masterpieces of Indian architecture



VERNACULAR ARCHITECTURE OF INDIA: Traditional Residential Styles & Spaces
by T.S. Randhawa
ATCHITECTURE AUTONOMOUS
₹4,500; 544 pages

This seminal book on the vernacular architecture of India by T.S. Randhawa, published by Gerard da Cunha of Architecture Autonomous, comes at the opportune moment when the destructive stride of steel and glass buildings has gripped the world with its tantalising possibilities. The potential of vernacular architecture has been open to the designers of modern India from the time of Tagore to a great revival in the works of Laurie Baker, Nari Gandhi, Didi Contractor, to name a few. The book has broken new ground in the subject covering the length and breadth of India geographically. The book within its 546 pages of splendidly reproduced images accompanied by sparing yet pithy text will be a delight for the lay reader as well as the professional. A first of its kind, this book is a collector's item that challenges much of the modernist aspirations of those who produce and inhabit contemporary architecture.

The author has divided the book into sections addressing the vernacular variations in India

FOCUS PEAKING

BOOKS

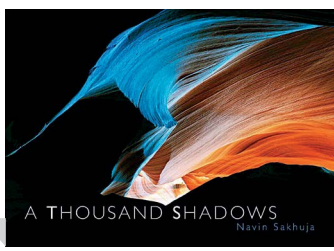
Navin Sakhuja brings precision and intimacy to landscape photography in *A Thousand Shadows*

Thousand Shadows by Navin Sakhuja is, on the surface, a book of lavish landscapes. It holds images that have been created during his personal photographic trips into some of the most popular, pictorially rich landscape destinations of the world. The skilled camera gleans heaps of striking and aesthetically satisfying pictures. But then it has its own challenges.

The photographs first suffuse the mind's eye with their familiarity—with similar looking images that populate Google image searches, social media shares, travel and tourism sites, Living Planet documentaries and memories of *National Geographic* magazine. The sensual gradations of textured light in the sand canyons of Arizona, the jewelled ice crystals, aglow with remnants of light, and the shadow-sculpted dunes of the Namib Desert—beautiful to behold—blur in our Instagram-baked eyes that are forever seeking newer stimuli. You flip through the enormous pages of the book as if on a touchscreen.

It is here that the artist—an eye surgeon by profession—performs a subtle procedure for the gaze.

It starts with a gentle pause of the author's text introducing each of



A THOUSAND SHADOWS
by Navin Sakhuja
SELF-PUBLISHED
₹5,500; 144 pages



